the world" (p. 129). It is as if he or any other book of religion had actually found the answer to the purpose of God's having created the world. One would have thought that the only answer any philosophy or philosophy of religion could possibly find was that no philosophy or religion has any answer to these ultimate questions. If one knows the answer before he even understands the question, as Zaehner seems to do, he only sound absurder than the absurd. One more of his quotations concerning the *Gītā* is worth giving here. "To sum up, Brahman in the *Gītā* is cosmologically primal matter *(prakṛti,* or Māyā); psychologically, it is the realization of immortality. The confusion is appalling" (p. 126). There may be many confusions in the *Gītā,* but this summing up of the entire text of the *Gītā* is more than appalling. Zaehner in great irony and praise of the *Bhagavad Gītā* says, "this is the highest Word, the 'most mysterious of all,' a thing unheard of in India before—God loves man" (p. 133). If this unheard-of-before message of God's loving man appears in the *Bhagavad Gītā* as Zaehner says, does he realize that the message was heard of much before Christ, or not much later than that, even if the latest dates are accepted for the *Mahābhārata.* Finally, "the *Gītā* offers the promise, not yet the fulfillment" (p. 179). This is obvious, because the fulfillment, for the author, had to come as if by a cosmic law only in the form of the New Testament.

To conclude, if the sole purpose of Zaehner's *The Comparison of Religions* was to prove, by a travesty of reasoning, that no religion in the world except orthodox and dogmatic Christianity is a religion at all or can possibly meet any religious need of man, Zaehner need not have taken the trouble to write two hundred pages to *prove* it.

NOTES

1. Robert C. Zaehner, *The Comparison of Religions* (Boston: Beacon Press, 1962). Page numbers in parentheses throughout this chapter refer to Zaehner, *The Comparison of Religions.*
2. Italics mine.
3. Italics mine.
4. See "Testimony in Indian Philosophy," this volume, chapter 3.
5. Italics mine.